



GET LUCKY GOLF × BUSINESS PLAN

A golf day in your pocket · August 2026 · Confidential

In one line: the only money-game app with a \$100,000 insured jackpot on the slip. The fourball's bet card — skins, nassau, dots, teams — with a live ledger, netted settlement, and a Santam-underwritten prize the whole group buys into. Peer games are free forever; Get Lucky earns from a \$10/month subscription and insured jackpot entries — never from the players' bets.

Why we pivoted

The previous product asked a golfer to film every swing at a 1-in-12,500 prize. At a realistic 8 attempts a month, 99 in 100 members would never once experience a win — and each attempt cost the whole fourball a filming stop. The money game fixes both: someone wins **every hole** (a skins-and-dots round produces 25–54 personal wins a year), verification becomes social, and filming is reserved for the one staged hole with an insured jackpot on it. The hole-in-one keeps a better job than it had: the lottery ticket at the till of a shop you were coming to anyway.

The product

The Slip	Built in under a minute: the four, handicaps auto-pulled (every allowance visible and overridable), the game stack, the group jackpot. Sent to the group chat; accepted in one tap with nothing to download; each player's maximum exposure stated before accepting; locks at the first tee.
Formats (v1)	Skins (gross/net, carryovers) · nassau with presses · team better-ball · dots (greenies, sandies, the snake — the micro-wins layer) · peer-verified closest-to-the-pin and longest drive
The jackpot	Group-pooled: the fourball buys in together — \$1 each at \$500 up to \$100 each at \$100,000 — and any ace pays the group. Four filmed swings on one designated hole; verified by Get Lucky; paid by the insurer.
Settlement	Netted to the fewest transfers at the 18th; deep-links to the payment apps the group already uses; a carry-forward ledger for the rest. Get Lucky routes nothing and holds nothing.
Retention	The Season Ledger — lifetime P&L against each named mate — plus one-tap rematch, order of merit, named groups. Nobody deletes the app while they are down to Dave.
Responsible play	Maximum-exposure display, table-stakes caps, self-set loss limits, cooling-off — and Pride Mode (points only) as the default state , which is also the compliant mode for restrictive markets.
Launch	USD-led global, honour mode: the full experience works everywhere from day one because the app never touches money. Wallets are a later, market-by-market unlock behind geo-flags, only where licensed.

Why no rake — the structural decision

Private bets between players are lawful precisely while **no third party takes a fee or holds the pot** — in South Africa by statute (the informal-bet exemption fails the moment anyone is paid a fee), in the US by precedent (a peer-betting exchange received a cease-and-desist at a 1% commission). Every durable competitor converged on the same structure: Skins App, the category leader, charges \$40/year flat and rakes nothing. Get Lucky therefore takes **zero from peer games, permanently** — peer money in play (~\$2.2m across 2029) is an engagement KPI, not a revenue line — and monetises the subscription and the insured jackpot instead. This is simultaneously the legal necessity, the proven category structure, and the honest pitch.

Market & competition

Category proof	18Birdies reports 10m+ golfers on a free scoring app — and Ernie Els was its first official investor . Golfers adopt round-companion apps at tens-of-millions scale.
The money-game niche	Skins App (\$40/yr flat, no rake, no custody) leads; Beezer, SettleUp, 18Birdies side games all track-only. Proven demand, shallow monetisation.
What nobody else can do	Put an insured \$100,000 on the slip. That takes an underwriter, actuarial credibility, a claims process and verification infrastructure — proven here over 10,000 entries, backed by a JSE-listed insurer and 25 camera-rigged courses.
18Birdies & conflict	Complementary, not competing: it cannot underwrite a jackpot, its side games are points-only, and Ernie sits on both cap tables — making it a natural partner or acquirer.

The model

	2027	2029 — 3-yr plan	2032
Subscribers · actives	3,436 · 9,620	7,398 · 20,714	14,061 · 39,371
Peer money in play revenue: zero	\$0.7m	\$2.2m	\$4.3m
Subscriptions	R4.4m	R14.2m	R28.1m
Insured jackpot net 66%	R2.8m	R9.2m	R18.2m
Courses · simulators · sponsorship	R6.9m	R21.0m	R50.9m
Total revenue	R14.1m	R44.4m	R97.2m
EBITDA margin	8.7%	24.1%	26.9%
Milestone flat 3.0×	R53.3m this round	R133.1m · 2.50×	R291.6m · 5.47×

Assumptions a sceptic can check: churn 5.5%/month (worse than the old plan, deliberately), jackpot attach 35% of slips (20% sceptic / 55% bull) at a \$10 average ticket, 2.8 actives per subscriber, one money round per active per month. Verification is charged on insured swings only — peer games verify themselves. Peak cumulative drawdown R2.3m against the R8m raise; EBITDA positive from 2027; no further round assumed. Implied IRR ~36% over three years from January 2027 — an unrealised mark, not a realised return.

The decisive number — and the 90-day pilot

The jackpot attach rate on a group slip has never been observed, because nobody has offered this product. So it gets measured before the app is finished: a **90-day manual pilot across the 25 installed courses** — real slips, real jackpots, the existing camera rigs — reading slip creation, jackpot attach and

average ticket. Above ~30%, the plan is conservative. Below ~15%, the company course-corrects with the capital intact. Investors are invited to hold the company to this milestone.

Gating milestones before launch

1 · Written counsel opinion on the P2P layer (the existing insured-challenge opinion does not cover it). 2 · **Santam's written sign-off on the peer-game wrapper.** 3 · Ernie Els's counsel sign-off. 4 · Geo-gating feature flags from the first commit. 5 · The pilot, published.

Team & the raise

Johannes le Roux (Founder & MD — built the proof of concept) · founding team of consumer-brand operators · **Ernie Els** (founding shareholder, **investing in this round**; four majors; first official investor in 18Birdies) · **Cloud & Things** (technology partner, led by the former CTO of Capitec Bank — owns the app build, verification flow and simulator SDK) · **Santam** (Authorised FSP 3416 — underwriter; R9m contracted sponsor).

R8.0m for 15% — R45.3m pre / R53.3m post. Minimum ticket R1m (1.88%). Use of funds: app build 35% · pilot 10% · simulators 15% · market entry 25% · legal & ops 15%.

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